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The Command to Be Baptized

KEY SCRIPTURES

- **Acts 2:38** “Repent and be baptized, every one of you...”
- **Matthew 28:19** “Go therefore and make disciples... baptizing them...”
- **Mark 16:16** “Whoever believes and is baptized will be saved...”

KEY IDEA

- Baptism is not optional for the believer.
- It is a command from Jesus.
- It is the first public act of obedience after repentance and faith.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Why did Jesus include baptism in the Great Commission?
2. What does it communicate when someone delays baptism?
3. Is baptism a suggestion or a command?

What Baptism Represents

KEY SCRIPTURES

- **Romans 6:3-4** “We were buried with Him through baptism into death... that we too may live a new life.”
- **Colossians 2:12** “Buried with Him in baptism and raised with Him through faith.”
- **2 Corinthians 5:17** “If anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation...”

KEY IDEA

- Baptism is an outward declaration of an inward transformation.
It represents death to the old life, burial of sin, and resurrection into new life.
- The water does not save you. Jesus saves you.
- Baptism publicly declares that your old life is gone and you belong to Him.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. What does it mean that your old self has been buried?
2. Are there parts of your old life you are still holding onto?
3. Why does Jesus want this declaration to be public?



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Repentance and Baptism Go Together

KEY SCRIPTURES

- **Acts 2:41** “Those who accepted his message were baptized...”
- **Acts 8:12** “When they believed... they were baptized...”
- **Acts 22:16** “What are you waiting for? Get up, be baptized...”

KEY IDEA

- In the New Testament pattern:
 - People heard the Gospel.
 - They repented.
 - They believed.
 - They were baptized.
 - There was no long delay.
 - There was immediate obedience.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. What are common reasons people delay baptism today?
2. Are those reasons found in Scripture?
3. If you have repented and believed, what is stopping you?

Baptism Is for Believers

KEY SCRIPTURES

- **Acts 16:31-33** “Believe in the Lord Jesus... then immediately he was baptized.”
- **Acts 18:8** “Many who heard believed and were baptized.”

KEY IDEA

- Belief precedes baptism.
- Baptism follows personal repentance and faith.
- It is not based on age. It is based on belief.
- If a child understands the Gospel and repents, they can be baptized.
- If an adult comes to faith later in life, they should be baptized.
- Obedience is not limited by age.



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DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Do you believe baptism should follow personal faith?
2. How do we discern if someone is ready for baptism?
3. Have you personally repented and believed?

Why Age Does Not Disqualify

KEY SCRIPTURES

- **Acts 10:47-48** “Can anyone keep these people from being baptized?”
- **Galatians 3:27** “All of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ.”

KEY IDEA

- Baptism is about obedience to Jesus, not stage of life.
- The early church baptized new believers immediately.
- There was no spiritual retirement age.
- There was no minimum prestige level.
- If you have been transformed inwardly, you are called to declare it outwardly.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. If God has changed you, why hide it?
2. What would it look like to boldly declare your faith publicly?
3. Is fear keeping you from obedience?

What Baptism Is Not

- Baptism is not a family tradition.
- Baptism is not a cultural ritual.
- Baptism is not a church membership requirement.
- Baptism is not a replacement for repentance.
- It does not save you. It follows salvation. It confirms allegiance to Jesus as Lord.



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Heart Check

KEY SCRIPTURES

- **Luke 9:26** "Whoever is ashamed of Me..."
- **John 14:15** "If you love Me, keep My commands."

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

1. Have I repented and trusted Jesus?
2. Have I been baptized as a believer?
3. If not, why am I waiting?
4. Is fear, pride, or misunderstanding holding me back?

Practical Baptism Plan

- Have I truly repented and believed?
- If yes, schedule baptism soon.
- Invite family and friends to witness your declaration.
- Share your testimony publicly.
- Walk forward in new life.

PERSONAL ACTION QUESTIONS

1. When did I give my life to Jesus?
2. Was I baptized after that decision?
3. If not, when will I obey?
4. Who will I invite to witness this step?

Closing Prayer Prompt

Lord Jesus, thank You for saving me. Thank You for making me new. Give me courage to obey You fully. If I have delayed baptism, help me take this step in faith. Let my life boldly declare that I belong to You. Amen.